

Detroit Police Department

Patrol Division — Traffic Services
1300 Beaubien Street, Detroit, MI 48226

OFFICIAL TRAFFIC COLLISION REPORT

(313) 555-0177 | Emergency: 911

CASE NUMBER	DPD-26-02-07-2218	WEATHER	Black Ice / Freezing Drizzle / 31°F
DATE OF INCIDENT	February 7, 2026	LIGHT CONDITIONS	Dawn / Low-light
TIME OF INCIDENT	07:33 hrs	ROADWAY SURFACE	Black Ice (drizzle-glazed)
LOCATION	I-75 Northbound, Mile Marker 52.4 (E McNichols Road overpass), Detroit, MI 48234	TYPE OF COLLISION / VEHICLES	4-vehicle chain + jackknifed tractor-trailer / 5 units

SECTION 1 — RESPONDING UNITS

Responding Agency	Detroit Police Department
Investigating Officer	Officer Keisha T. Armstrong, Badge #7741
Officer Phone	(313) 555-0177 ext. 812
EMS Agency	Detroit EMS — Units 7, 12, and 18 (transported six occupants); Detroit Fire Rescue Heavy Rescue
Tow Companies	Motor City Recovery (Semi, V3, V4); owner (V1, V2)
Additional Units	Sgt. L. Patterson #3318; MSP Trooper C. Nichols; MDOT Emergency Response; Detroit Fire Heavy Rescue

SECTION 2 — VEHICLES

#	Year / Make / Model	VIN	Plate	Damage
V1	2021 Toyota Camry	4T1G11AK2MU081801	MI-AJP-4418 (MI)	Rear bumper deformed; minor — drivable
V2	2020 Honda Pilot	5FNYP8H20LB041801	MI-BKR-8821 (MI)	Front and rear deformed; both airbags deployed; windshield cracked; severe
V3	2019 Chevrolet Traverse	1GNEVJKW9KJ141801	MI-CTX-3319 (MI)	Front bumper, hood, grille destroyed; airbag deployed; frame bend suspected; total loss likely
V4	2022 Ford F-250	1FT8W2BT9NEE81801	MI-DLM-7723 (MI)	Front end destroyed; airbag deployed; frame severely bent — total loss
Semi	2016 Freightliner Cascadia (tractor-trailer, CMV — 48 ft refrigerated)	3AKJGBDV7GSBJ1801	MI-CMV-441 (MI)	Jackknifed — refrigerated trailer 70 degrees; tractor cab front destroyed; refrigerant line ruptured; CMV out of service

SECTION 3 — DRIVERS / OPERATORS

Party	Name	DOB	License	Citation
Driver V1	Dorothy M. Jackson	05/12/1959	MI-J44218301	None
Driver V2	Stefan B. Kowalski	10/03/1982	MI-K88234107	MI MCL §257.643a — Assured Clear Distance Ahead
Driver V3	Carmen A. Reyes	07/28/1990	MI-R77187213	MI MCL §257.643a — Assured Clear Distance Ahead
Driver V4	Hassan T. Ahmed	03/14/1977	MI-A44219801	MI MCL §257.643a — Assured Clear Distance Ahead
Operator Semi (CMV)	Gerald D. Kramer	09/22/1962	MI-CDL-K88241307	MI MCL §257.643a — Assured Clear Distance; FMCSA 49 CFR §392.14 — CMV Hazardous Conditions

SECTION 4 — PASSENGERS

Veh	Name	DOB	Injury	Transported
V2	Irena S. Kowalski	12/18/1984	Critical: severe head trauma, unresponsive at scene, suspected TBI	Yes — Detroit EMS Unit 7, to Detroit Receiving Hospital Trauma (trauma activation)
V2	Dmitri P. Kowalski	04/27/2015	Serious: right arm fracture, airbag burns, forehead laceration	Yes — Detroit EMS Unit 12, to Childrens Hospital of Michigan (serious)
V3	Elena M. Reyes	08/06/1992	Serious: cervical fracture (suspected), airbag facial burns	Yes — Detroit EMS Unit 12, to Detroit Receiving Hospital (serious)
V4	Layla K. Ahmed	06/14/1980	Moderate: rib contusion, shoulder dislocation	Yes — Detroit EMS Unit 18, to Henry Ford Hospital (stable)
V4	Yusuf H. Ahmed	09/09/2008	Moderate: cervical strain, wrist sprain; booster seat intact	Yes — Detroit EMS Unit 18, to Childrens Hospital of Michigan (stable)
V1	Edna T. Jackson	02/22/1961	Minor: cervical stiffness — declined transport after evaluation	No

SECTION 5 — WITNESSES

#	Name	Address	Phone	Statement
W1	Nathaniel P. Ford	Following motorist, stopped safely	(313) 555-0341	Yes — confirmed five-unit sequence; observed semi jackknife; written statement
W2	Delores M. Chambers	Pedestrian on McNichols overpass above	(313) 555-0448	Yes — overhead view; observed trailer swing in real time; verbal statement recorded
W3	MSP Trooper C. Nichols #314	MSP Metro North Post, arrived 07:42 hrs	MSP Internal	Yes — co-investigated; MSP UD-10 filed; EDR requests initiated
W4	Marcus T. Givens	Adjacent southbound motorist — parallel observation	(313) 555-0512	Yes — observed semi approaching fast in opposite direction prior to scene; verbal statement

SECTION 6 — PROPERTY DAMAGE (NON-VEHICLE)

	I-75 NB right shoulder Armco barrier at MM 52.3 — semi trailer contact; 6-panel section buckled. MDOT Emergency notified. Refrigerant (R-404A) line rupture from semi trailer — HAZMAT protocol initiated; Detroit Fire Heavy Rescue containment completed at 09:11 hrs.
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SECTION 7 — NARRATIVE

On Saturday February 7, 2026 at approximately 07:33 hrs, this officer, Sgt. Patterson, MSP Trooper Nichols, MDOT Emergency Response, and Detroit Fire Heavy Rescue were dispatched to I-75 northbound at Mile Marker 52.4 near the McNichols Road overpass in Detroit on report of a five-unit collision involving a jackknifed refrigerated tractor-trailer with multiple serious injuries, a refrigerant leak, and a HAZMAT situation. Freezing drizzle had been falling since approximately 05:00 hrs, creating a glaze of black ice on all road surfaces. Temperature was 31°F. Visibility was acceptable at approximately 500 feet but the black ice surface was visually indistinguishable from wet pavement. V1 (2021 Toyota Camry, Jackson) was traveling northbound in the center lane at a cautiously reduced speed. Jackson had recognized the ice conditions and activated hazard lights. V1 slowed for congestion ahead and came to a near-stop. V2 (2020 Honda Pilot, Kowalski) was following V1 and failed to stop in time on the ice-glazed surface, striking V1's rear at approximately 35 mph. V2 came to an angled stop blocking the center and right lanes, deploying both front airbags. V3 (2019 Chevrolet Traverse, Reyes) struck V2's rear with significant force; the impact suspected to have produced frame deformation in V3. V4 (2022 Ford F-250, Ahmed) struck V3's rear at an estimated 50 mph; witness Ford described V4 as approaching at a rate considerably higher than other vehicles. V4 was pushed forward into V3 and then into V2, creating a three-stage accordion at the V2-V3-V4 grouping. The semi (2016 Freightliner Cascadia, operator Kramer — Arctic Transport LLC, USDOT #3214441) was approaching at an estimated 55–60 mph and was unable to stop on the ice. Kramer applied brakes, causing the refrigerated trailer to swing and jackknife to approximately 70 degrees. The tractor cab struck the V3-V4 grouping; the trailer struck the right shoulder Armco barrier and ruptured the trailer's refrigerant (R-404A) supply line. Detroit Fire Heavy Rescue personnel responded to the refrigerant leak. R-404A (a hydrofluorocarbon blend) is non-flammable but poses an asphyxiation risk in concentrated areas. Personnel deployed air monitoring equipment; ambient levels at scene were within safe thresholds due to outdoor ventilation and wind. Containment of the rupture was completed at 09:11 hrs by Kramer's employer's emergency maintenance crew, who arrived at 08:44 hrs. MDOT and MDEQ were notified per hazardous material release protocols. V2 passenger Irena Kowalski was found unresponsive at the scene with severe head trauma; she was transported under trauma activation to Detroit Receiving Hospital. V2 passenger Dmitri Kowalski, age 10 (child seat deformed), was transported in serious condition to Children's Hospital of Michigan. V3 passenger Elena Reyes was transported with a suspected cervical fracture. V4 passengers Layla and Yusuf Ahmed were transported with moderate injuries, Yusuf (age 17, booster seat intact) to Children's Hospital of Michigan. V1 passenger Edna Jackson declined transport after EMS evaluation. Operator Kramer was uninjured. Driver Jackson and drivers V5/V6 were uninjured.

SECTION 9 — SUPPLEMENTAL INVESTIGATION NOTES

SUPPLEMENTAL — HAZMAT REFRIGERANT RESPONSE AND CMV INSPECTION: HAZMAT: R-404A (1,1,1-trifluoroethane blend) was released from the semi trailer's refrigerant supply line at an estimated rate of 2–3 lbs/min at the time of initial assessment. Detroit Fire Heavy Rescue Unit 1 deployed four-gas monitors (LEL, O2, H2S, CO) at 07:51 hrs. Readings at scene perimeter: LEL 0%, O2 20.8% (normal), refrigerant detectable but below IDLH threshold. Full northbound lane closure maintained during HAZMAT assessment. Arctic Transport LLC Emergency Response (contractor Frost Control Services) arrived at 08:44 hrs and completed line isolation and system purge at 09:11 hrs. MDEQ Spill Report #MI-2026-0207-DET-441 filed by Arctic Transport. Total refrigerant released estimated at 18 lbs; no surface contamination; no groundwater risk. CMV INSPECTION: Semi (Freightliner Cascadia, USDOT #3214441) placed out of service per FMCSA §396.9. MSP Trooper Nichols Level I inspection findings: (1) Left front steer tire — 0.021 in tread remaining (below 0.098 in minimum) — OOS violation; (2) Rear trailer tandem right brake — s-cam spring fractured — OOS violation; (3) Operator Kramer's ELD showed 8.7 hours on-duty driving preceding 12 hours — within HOS. Two OOS violations represent significant pre-existing mechanical deficiencies potentially contributing to braking failure on ice. Full CMV inspection report and ELD download pending. MEDICAL UPDATES: Irena Kowalski — Detroit Receiving Trauma: CT confirmed bilateral subdural hematoma; emergency craniotomy performed at 09:14 hrs; in critical post-surgical condition as of 12:00 hrs. Elena Reyes — confirmed C5 stable fracture; admitted neurosurgical service; no surgical intervention planned. CHILD SEAT: Dmitri Kowalski (age 10, forward-facing harness deformed) — seat replacement mandatory. Yusuf Ahmed (age 17, booster) — intact; replacement recommended. I-75 CLOSURE: Full NB closure Exit 50 to Exit 54 from 07:48 to 11:22 hrs. MDOT activated Incident Management Plan; diversion via M-3 (Gratiot Avenue).

SECTION 10 — CITATIONS / CHARGES SUMMARY

Party	Statute	Violation	Fine / Disposition
Driver V2 (Kowalski)	MI MCL §257.643a	Assured Clear Distance — black ice	Civil Infraction
Driver V3 (Reyes)	MI MCL §257.643a	Assured Clear Distance — black ice	Civil Infraction
Driver V4 (Ahmed)	MI MCL §257.643a	Assured Clear Distance — black ice	Civil Infraction
Operator Semi (Kramer)	MI MCL §257.643a	Assured Clear Distance — CMV/black ice	Civil Infraction
Operator Semi (Kramer)	49 CFR §392.14	CMV Operation in Hazardous Conditions	Federal — FMCSA

SECTION 8 — OFFICER SIGN-OFF

signed

Officer Keisha T. Armstrong, Badge #7741

Investigating Officer, Detroit Police Department Traffic Services

February 7, 2026

Date